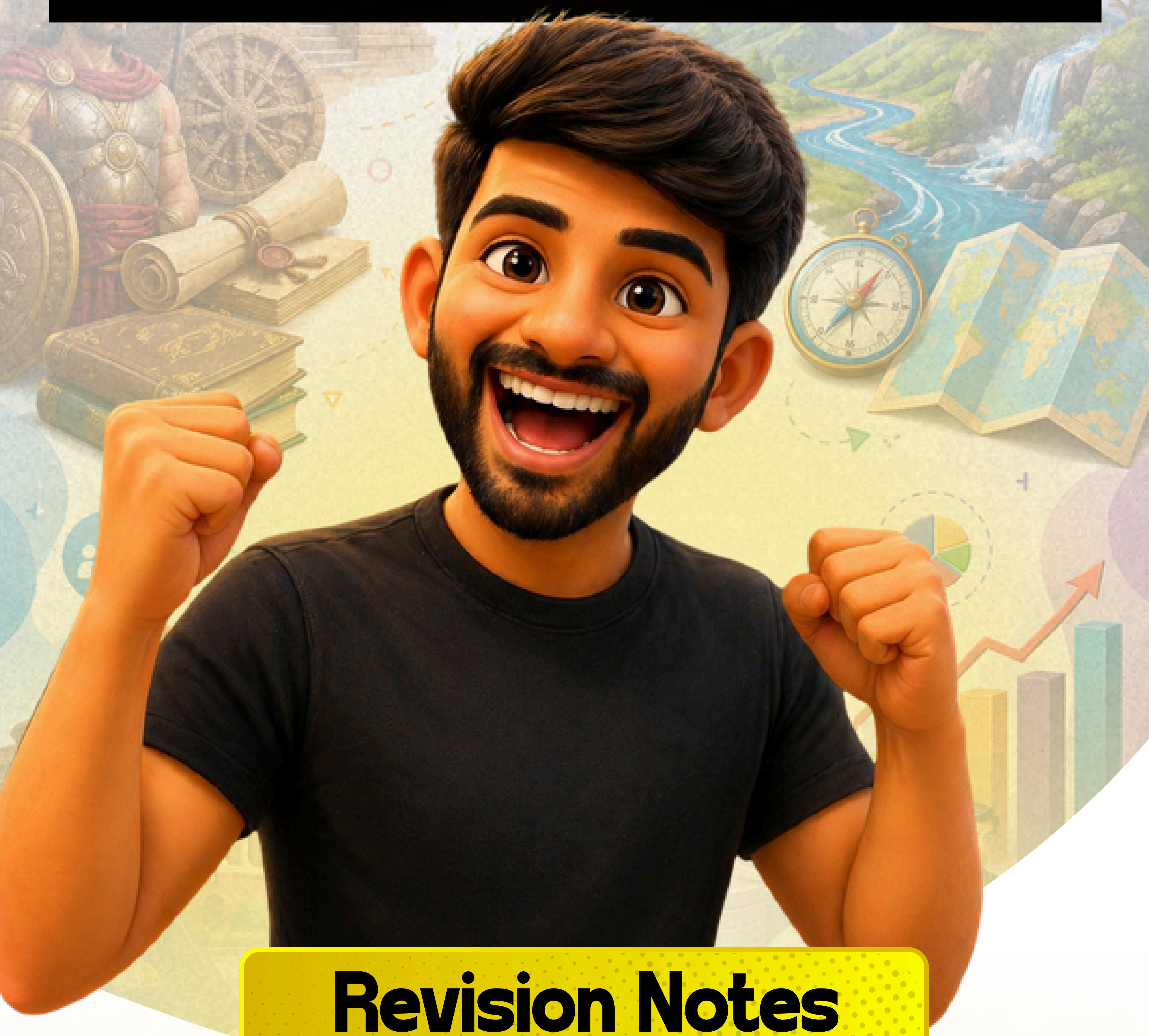


Class 10th **Geography**

FOREST & WILDLIFE RESOURCES



Revision Notes

Crafted with ❤️
Digraj Singh Rajput

Forest And Wildlife Resources

Importance of Biodiversity and Our Dependence on Nature



We share Earth with many living beings – like tiny bacteria, plants, trees, animals, and even big whales. All living things, including humans, are part of nature – and we depend on this natural system to live. Nature keeps us alive – plants, animals, and tiny organisms clean the air and water, and help grow food. Forests are very important – they support the entire system as the main source of food and energy for all life.

Biodiversity or Biological diversity

Biodiversity or Biological Diversity is immensely rich in wildlife and cultivated species, diverse in form and function but closely integrated in a system through multiple network of interdependencies.



Flora and Fauna in India

India is one of the world's richest countries in terms of its vast array of biological diversity. Importance of flora and fauna in our daily life. They are under great stress, mainly due to insensitivity to our environment.



Conservation of forest and wildlife in India



Indian Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972 – Published an all-India list of protected species. Banned hunting and protected habitats of endangered animals. Restricted trade in wildlife.



Central and many state governments established national parks and wildlife sanctuaries.



Special projects launched to protect endangered animals like the tiger, the one horned rhinoceros, the Kashmir stag or hangul, three types of crocodiles – freshwater crocodile, saltwater crocodile and the Gharial, the Asiatic lion. Legal protection extended to species such as the Indian elephant, black buck (chinkara), the great Indian bustard (godawan) and the snow leopard.



Conservation efforts shifted from protecting a few species to conserving overall biodiversity. Insects (butterflies, moths, beetles, dragonflies) were added to the protected list in 1980 and 1986. Plants were included in the protected species list for the first time in 1991.

Project Tiger

- Tigers are important animals in the forest food chain. Tiger numbers dropped from 55,000 to just 1,827 by 1973 due to hunting, loss of forests, and fewer prey animals.
- Poaching was a big threat, especially for their skin and bones used in traditional medicines. India and Nepal are home to two-thirds of the world's tigers, so they were main targets for illegal trade. Project Tiger was started in 1973 to save tigers and also protect large forest areas (biotypes).



📍 Corbett National Park – Uttarakhand

📍 Sundarbans National Park – West Bengal

📍 Bandhavgarh National Park – Madhya Pradesh

📍 Sariska Wildlife Sanctuary – Rajasthan

📍 Manas Tiger Reserve – Assam

📍 Periyar Tiger Reserve – Kerala

Types and Distribution of Forest and Wildlife Resources

Classification of forests



Reserved Forests:

More than half of the total forest land has been declared reserved forests. Reserved forests are regarded as the most valuable as far as the conservation of forest and wildlife resources are concerned.



Protected Forests:

Almost one-third of the total forest area is protected forest, as declared by the Forest Department. This forest land are protected from any further depletion.



Unclassed Forests:

These are other forests and wastelands belonging to both government and private individuals and communities.



Maintained for the purpose of producing timber and other forest produce, and for protective reasons.



Madhya Pradesh has the largest area under permanent forests, constituting 75 per cent of its total forest area.



Jammu and Kashmir, Andhra Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, and Maharashtra have large percentages of reserved forests of its total forest area.



Whereas Bihar, Haryana, Punjab, Himachal Pradesh, Odisha and Rajasthan have a bulk of it under protected forests.



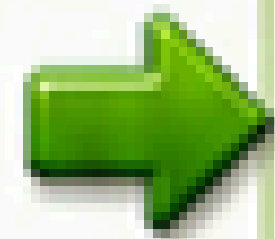
All North-eastern states and parts of Gujarat have a very high percentage of their forests as unclassified forests managed by local communities.

Community and Conservation



In some areas of India, local communities are struggling to conserve these habitats along with government officials, recognising that only this will secure their own long-term livelihood.

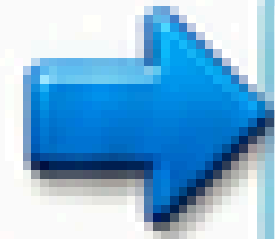
Example:



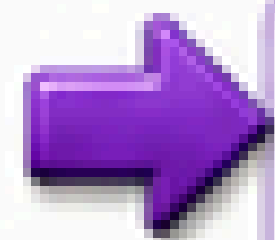
Sariska Tiger Reserve (Rajasthan): Villagers used the Wildlife Protection Act to stop mining and protect forests.



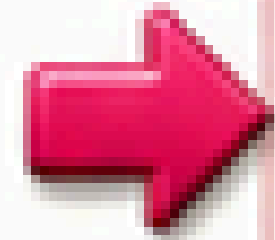
Bhairodev Dakav Sonchuri (Alwar, Rajasthan): Five villages protected 1,200 hectares of forest by banning hunting and preventing encroachments.



Chipko Movement: Successfully resisted deforestation and promoted community afforestation using indigenous species.



Beej Bachao Andolan (Tehri) & Navdanya: Encouraged crop diversity and organic farming without synthetic chemicals.

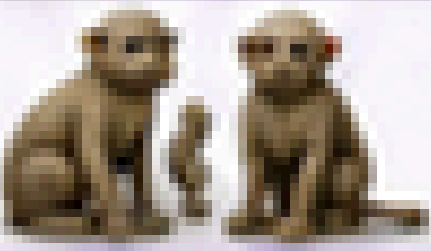


Joint Forest Management (JFM), 1988: Started in Odisha; local communities protect degraded forests and receive benefits like non-timber forest products and a share in timber harvest.

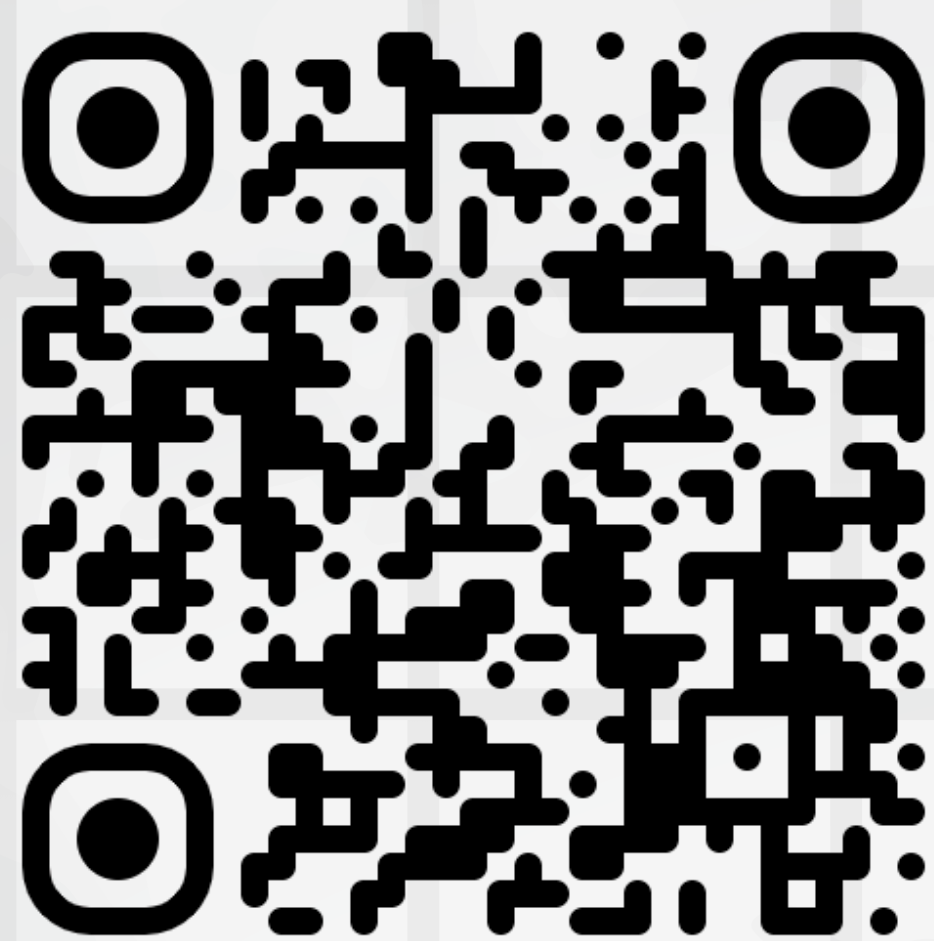
Sacred Groves – A Wealth of Diverse and Rare Species



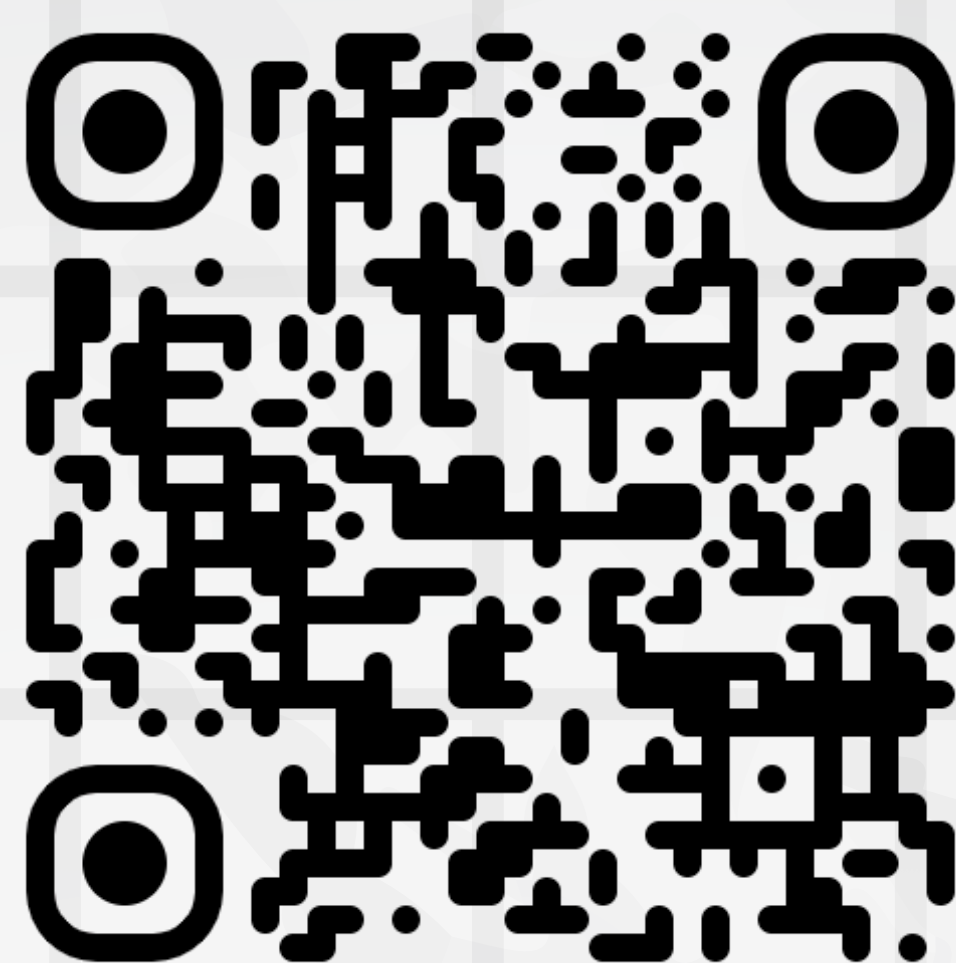
Nature worship led to the protection of Sacred Groves (forests of gods and goddesses). These forest patches are left untouched, and any interference is banned. As a result, several virgin forests and rare species have been preserved.

Sacred Grove/Species	Location/Community
 Mahua and Kadamba trees	 Mundas and Santhals in Chota Nagpur region
 Tamarind and Mango trees	 Tribals of Odisha and Bihar
 Peepal and Banyan trees	 Considered sacred across many parts of India
 Macaques and Langurs	 Around temples across India
 Blackbuck, Nilgai, Peacocks	 Bishnoi villages in Rajasthan

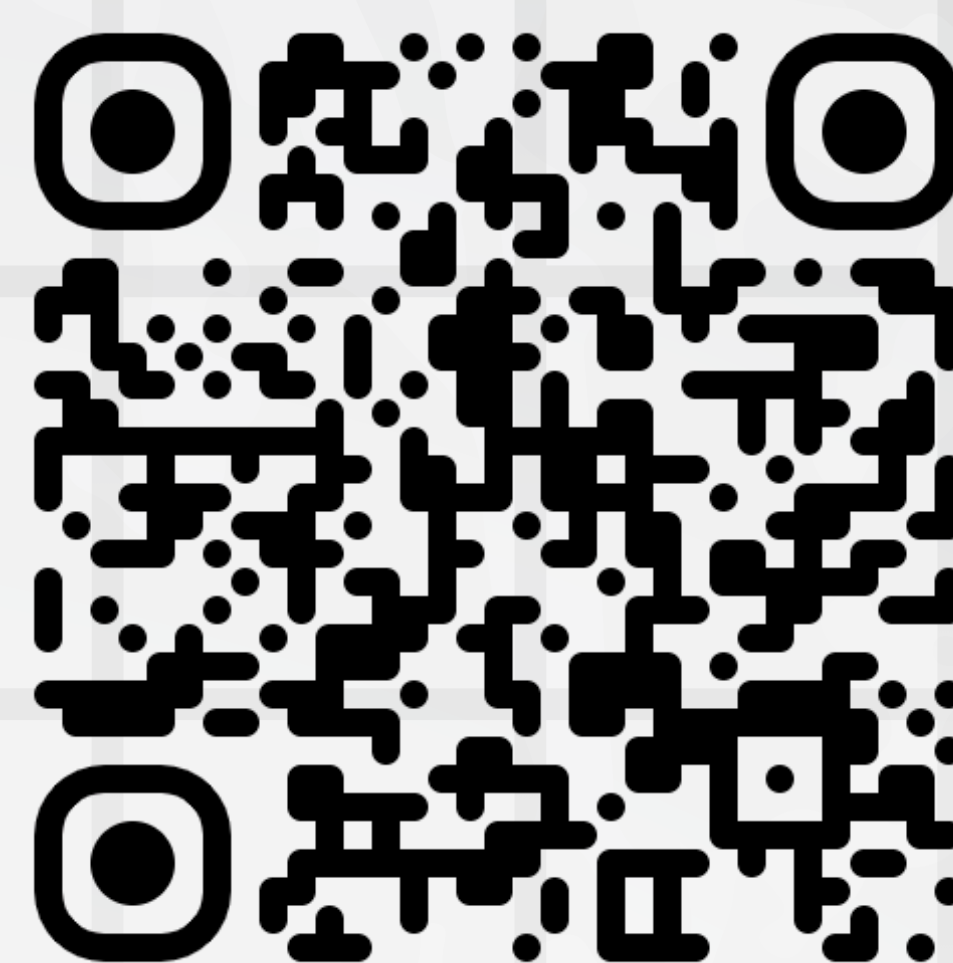
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Together
We Can
We Will

